INTRODUCTION

Ethical marketing refers to fair, transparent, responsible, and socially conscious practices in marketing activities. As consumers become increasingly aware of issues such as environmental responsibility, transparency, and responsible business practices, ethical considerations may influence how they evaluate brands and make purchasing decisions.

This study examines consumer responses to various aspects of ethical marketing and their relationship with consumer decision-making. A primary survey was conducted using Google Forms, and 200 participants responded. The collected data were analysed using Microsoft Excel to examine patterns in consumer responses through descriptive statistics, including mean, median, and standard deviation, along with selected Pearson correlation and simple linear regression analyses.

The study focuses on factors including environmental practices, brand transparency and trust, ethical marketing, price considerations, willingness to pay more for ethical products, and social influence. The analysis aims to provide a quantitative perspective on how consumers respond to ethical marketing practices and the different factors that may be associated with their purchasing decisions.

This survey-based analysis builds upon the broader undergraduate research conducted on ethical marketing and consumer decision-making, providing a practical application of quantitative analysis to primary consumer data.

OBJECTIVES

The study was undertaken with the following objectives:

1.) To examine consumer perceptions of ethical marketing practices.
2.) To analyse the importance of factors such as brand transparency, environmental practices, price, and social influence in consumer decision-making.
3.) To examine consumers' willingness to choose ethical products and pay a higher price for them.
4.) To identify patterns and variations in consumer responses using descriptive statistical measures such as mean, median, and standard deviation.
5.) To examine selected relationships between ethical marketing factors and consumer decision-making using Pearson correlation analysis and simple linear regression.

RESEARCH METHODOLOGY

1.) Data Collection-

Primary data was collected through a structured questionnaire created using Google Forms. The survey received responses from 200 participants. The questionnaire included questions relating to consumer perceptions of ethical marketing, purchasing decisions, price considerations, and social influence.

The demographic information collected from respondents consisted of age and occupation. Age was provided by respondents as a numerical value and was subsequently grouped into age categories for analysis.

2.) Survey Scale-

The survey included statements measured using a five-point Likert scale, ranging from 1 to 5. The responses were analysed to identify patterns in consumer perceptions and decision-making related to ethical marketing practices.

3.) Data Analysis-

Frequency distributions were used to show how responses were spread across the five scale points. Means summarised average ratings, medians described the middle response, and standard deviations indicated variation in ratings. Pearson's correlation coefficient was used to describe the direction and strength of selected linear associations. Two simple linear regression models were then used to examine whether one survey rating was statistically associated with another. The analyses are exploratory and do not establish causation.

4.) Variables Examined-

The survey examined consumer responses relating to:

- Environmental practices
- Brand transparency and trust
- Ethical marketing and purchasing decisions
- Preference for chapter products
- Choosing ethical products
- Willingness to pay more for ethical products
- Importance of price
- Social influence

RESPONDENT PROFILE

The age distribution of the 200 respondents was as follows:-

AGE GROUP	RESPONDENTS	SHARE
17-20	24	12%
21-30	80	40%
31-40	63	31.5%
41-50	31	15.5%
50+	2	1

Occupation categories recorded as:-

CATEGORY	RESPONDENTS	SHARE
Student	76	38%
Employed/Self Employed	65	32.5%
Not Currently Employed (Includes retired, homemakers, and job seekers)	59	29.5

DESCRIPTIVE ANALYSIS

The following table summarises the ratings for all eight survey questions. Means range from 3.05 to 3.21 on the five-point scale. All medians are 3. These averages are close to the scale midpoint, so they do not indicate strong overall agreement or disagreement. The standard deviations, all around 1.37–1.43, indicate a spread of responses rather than uniform views.

SURVEY VARIABLE	VALID N	MEAN	MEDIAN	SD
Environmental practices	200	3.050	3	1.385
Brand transparency and trust	200	3.150	3	1.431
Ethical marketing and purchase decision	200	3.135	3	1.392
Choosing a cheaper product	199	3.151	3	1.403
Actually choosing an ethical product	200	3.135	3	1.370
Willingness to pay more	200	3.055	3	1.397
Importance of price	200	3.210	3	1.384
Social influence	200	3.170	3	1.379

Key observations:-

- Importance of price had the highest mean rating (3.21), suggesting that price was a relevant consideration for respondents on average.
- Environmental practices had the lowest mean (3.05), though this is still close to the midpoint of the scale.
- Willingness to pay more for ethical products had a mean of 3.055. This average alone does not establish that respondents would consistently pay a premium.

- The mean for actually choosing an ethical product was 3.135. Responses varied, so the average should not be treated as proof of consistent ethical purchasing.

CORRELATION ANALYSIS

We calculated Pearson correlation coefficients for five selected pairs of variables. A coefficient closer to +1 indicates a stronger positive linear association, a coefficient closer to −1 indicates a stronger negative linear association, and a value near zero indicates little or no linear association.

VARIABLE PAIR	N	PEARSON r
Brand transparency and trust ↔ Ethical marketing and purchase decision	200	0.303
Ethical marketing and purchase decision ↔ Actually choosing an ethical product	200	0.091
Choosing a cheaper product ↔ Actually choosing an ethical product	200	0.058
Willingness to pay more ↔ Importance of price	200	-0.097
Actually choosing an ethical product ↔ Social influence	200	0.009

Key Observations from Correlation Analysis

1. **Brand Transparency and Trust:** Consumers who trust transparent brands are more likely to consider ethical marketing in their purchasing decisions. This was the strongest relationship found in the analysis.
2. **Ethical Marketing and Product Choice:** Positive attitudes towards ethical marketing do not necessarily result in consumers actually choosing ethical products.
3. **Price Preference and Ethical Choices:** Preferring cheaper products does not necessarily mean consumers avoid ethical products. The analysis found no meaningful relationship between the two.
4. **Willingness to Pay More:** Price-conscious consumers showed a slightly lower willingness to pay extra for ethical products, but the relationship was negligible.
5. **Social Influence:** Social influence did not show a meaningful connection with consumers' choices of ethical products.

Overall Conclusion: The analysis indicates that brand transparency and trust are associated with positive perceptions of ethical marketing. However, these perceptions do not necessarily translate

into actual purchasing choices. The findings suggest a gap between consumers' appreciation of ethical marketing and their reported buying behaviour.

LINEAR REGRESSION ANALYSIS

Regression A: Brand transparency and trust → ethical marketing and purchase decision
The first model examined whether higher ratings for trust in transparent brands were associated with higher ratings for being more likely to purchase from a company that follows ethical marketing practices.

Regression equation: $\hat{Y} = 2.208 + 0.294X$

MEASURE	RESULT
Valid responses	200
Slope	0.294
Intercept	2.208
Pearson r	0.303
R-squared	0.0916 (9.16%)
p-value	0.000013

The slope is positive (0.294), meaning that a one-point increase in the transparency-and-trust rating is associated with an estimated 0.294-point increase in the ethical-marketing purchase-decision rating on average. R-squared is 9.16%, meaning the model accounts for a modest share of variation in the outcome. The relationship is statistically significant in this sample ($p < .001$), but the model's explanatory power remains limited. Statistical significance does not imply causation.

Regression B: ethical marketing and purchase decision → actually choosing an ethical product
The second model examined whether respondents who rated themselves as more likely to purchase from companies following ethical marketing practices also reported more frequently choosing an ethically produced product over a cheaper alternative.

Regression equation: $\hat{Y} = 2.856 + 0.089X$

MEASURE	RESULT
Valid responses	200
Slope	0.089
Intercept	2.856
Pearson r	0.091
R-squared	0.0082 (0.82%)

p-value	0.202

The slope is positive but small (0.089). R-squared is only 0.82%, so this model explains very little of the variation in reported ethical-product choice. The association is not statistically significant at the conventional 5% level ($p = 0.202$). The data therefore do not provide sufficient evidence of a linear relationship between these two ratings in this sample.

Comparison of the two models

Regression A shows a modest positive association between transparency/trust and ethical-marketing purchase intention. Regression B shows little evidence of a linear association between purchase intention and reported ethical-product choice. Taken together, the models suggest that positive views about ethical marketing do not necessarily translate directly into reported ethical-product choices in this sample.